

1946, July 4

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by
the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

ST. FELIX FRIARY
HUNTINGTON, IND.

My Dear Brother Edward- Rt. Rev. Msgr.

God bless you and yours.

I sure hope you are well. I wrote a card to Fr. M. E. Joachim this morning and it's been on my mind all day that I should send you also a few lines. You can guess about the time if I say that just a year about this time you and I were passing through beautifully picturesque little Sta. Barbara, as nearing Los Angeles. Thanks be to God--and our dear ones adown the Coast,- was it not quite a privilege, all in all? Some day, D. v., I'll tell you of the rest of my trip after I and poor, dear Owen left you on the bus for Mt. Angeles. Suffice now to say that I arrived in Seattle that p.m. at 6:30 in Spokane, Tuesday at 7:15 a.m. in St. Paul Thurs. 10:30 p.m. on schedule; in Chicago about 6:30 p.m. Friday: Detroit Sat. at 4:30 p.m. Convent Mass next a.m.; New York and Brooklyn Monday a.m. and p.m. respectively. From Los Angeles Only missed two holy Masses, Deo gratias.

Well, you burried the mortal remains of poor dear Gus-Austin rather, since he preferred and as I told him, so much more like the real name of the great doctor of the Church. I would like to have details of his last days. He wrote me quite a touching letter from the hospital apparently after his first operation, seemingly quite cool and philosophical about what might come--and certainly with beautiful faith.

He evidently knew that he had cancer. Just a few of his words: "I have observed that very seldom is cancer cured... at least by surgery. "I am relying on the Sacred Heart to come to my rescue." ... "I was privileged to receive our Lord at 6 a.m. the morning they opened me; and again on the 2nd day (1st Friday), Thanks and praise to the Sacred Heart."

How beautifully condescending that the Merciful Sacred H't actually did come to his rescue on His own blessed Feast! He had written me a number of times to pray for Pat., even before he was sick. I am sure he was praying for his--their reconciliation, etc. and how beautifully did it not come about! How grateful we ought to be that we can confidently hope that we have another, another of our original sixteen--with dear Father and Mother--waving us from beyond the grave to follow their footsteps in keeping the faith, in praying for one another as among the INTERESTS OF THE SACRED HEART and striving manfully against the world, the flesh and the devil for the one great prize of the final BEATIFIC VISION. Mary Ann was the first to cross the border into eternity and saintly little Martha